BUILD NOTES · LEASING & TENANT SCREENING

Fast leasing without the *shortcuts*

What I built to speed up leasing without skipping verification, what broke, and what I learned.

Two pressures on every vacancy

01 **Move fast**

Slow replies lose renters to competitors.

02 **Verify thoroughly**

Rushing invites fake pay stubs and evictions.

Moving fast fills vacancies before competitors do. Moving too quickly lets falsified documents slip past, turning an empty unit into a costly eviction.

From inquiry to signed lease

FRONT OF FUNNEL

Inquiry	→	Grounded Q&A	→	Approved tour

UNDERWRITING

Application	→	Verify income	→	Manager signs

Every rental decision and lease send requires human approval.

I built a workflow that answers renter questions 24/7, schedules approved tours, collects applications, verifies income, and prepares files for decision.

AI assists. The manager decides.

AI assists

Answer property facts

Read uploaded pay stubs

Draft status messages

Manager decides

Review income proof

Set rental criteria

Approve every lease

AI answers factual questions and extracts document figures. The manager controls rental criteria, reviews discrepancies, and makes every rental decision before a lease sends.

Reconcile three income sources

01 **Stated income**
What the applicant typed on the form.

02 **Document income**
What the pay stub PDF actually states.

03 **Verified payroll**
Direct deposit data from verified bank records.

Instead of trusting a single PDF, the workflow compares application entries, extracted pay stub numbers, and verified payroll records. Any mismatch flags for review.

A guardrail created dead silence

THE GAP

Stated income → Assistant echoes → Safety block

Unlisted figure blocked

THE FIX

Stated income → Allow user figures → Send reply

Repeating a prospect's stated income triggered the safety guardrail because the figure was not a property fact. The conversation stalled until I allowed recorded user answers.

One character broke link delivery

THE BUG

Send link	→ Markdown parse	→ ~~Unclosed tag~~

THE FIX

Escape text	→ Pin HTML mode	→ Link delivered

An underscore in the link token was read as formatting.

An underscore in the application link token was parsed as Markdown formatting, causing silent delivery failure. I pinned the messaging mode to HTML and added character escaping.

Rejections require a person

SCREENING OUTCOME	WORKFLOW ACTION
Meets all criteria	Ready for manager
Income mismatch	Flag for review
Criteria not met	Stop for human review

Automating denials creates severe legal liability under credit reporting laws. If an applicant fails criteria, the workflow stops completely and hands the file to a human.

Guardrails need conversational context

The question

↓

The user reply

↓

The guardrail check

↓

The verified delivery

Strict rules prevent hallucinated rents, but conversations require natural acknowledgments. Building this taught me that guardrails must understand what the user just stated.

I checked the critical paths

I CHECKED	RECORDED BEHAVIOR
Grounded answers	Only verified facts quoted
Income mismatch	Flagged with three numbers
Link delivery	HTML token links sent intact
Repeated approval	No duplicate lease sent

I verified factual property answers, income discrepancy flags, link encoding, and duplicate click protection. These checks confirmed the pipeline behaves predictably.

What I'd improve next

01 **Multi-applicant files**
Evaluate combined household income and co-signers.

02 **Conversational reschedule**
Manage tour cancellations and changes in chat.

03 **Interrupted send recovery**
Reconcile webhook delivery if logging is interrupted.

Next, I would add support for multi-applicant households, automated tour rescheduling in chat, and recovery routines for interrupted webhook deliveries.